

Minutes – Cincinnati Contra Board Meeting

June 1, 2025 7:00 pm

Present: Steve Edwards, Philip Ogston, Cori Yaeger, Larry Lankford, Bonnie Carpenter, Michael Hentz, Myra Mitchell, Valerie Allendorf, Zoey Bryant (guest), Josh Telecsan, Audrey Eyman, Charles Wallner, Deven Corzine, John McCain (guest). **Absent:** Kurt Grannan.

Meeting began at 7:05pm

Introduction

Sound Board Proposal

From Larry:

“Since the repair could take three or more months, I propose an amount of \$2600 be approved for the purchase of a new mixer and a robust surge protector. I also propose that the sound team (John McCain, Josh Telecsan, Kurt Grannan, Zoey Bryant, and Larry Lankford) decide on which mixer to purchase. The total might be around \$2200.”

Discussion:

John McCain and Zoey Bryant of the sound engineer team attended the meeting to discuss the problems with the soundboard. It failed several weeks ago. John reported that he took the soundboard to a place in Columbus that might be able to repair. Repair would be \$850. Also could take months to repair it – as parts may take a long time. Warranty from that place would only be on parts. Current board has a problem with power supply fail and channel 2 fail.

Deven asked about whether we could use our OLD backup system until the current one is repaired. The OLD one does not work well enough for caller and for band members. Sound quality of OLD mixer is bad. Josh worked sound for last evening's waltz night, but it was a challenge. Discussion included options of getting a cheaper board, fixing current board and using old analog board as back up, or buying new board and repairing current board and using that as back up. Josh suggested we might buy power conditioner for the board as well as surge protector.

Larry researched the option of purchasing a new soundboard (same system with upgrade – that we don't really need.) Version that we have is discontinued but Larry found one on sale.

Above proposal did not include the \$200 diagnostic fee from the Columbus firm. Zoey indicated that our old one was often dusty – maybe make sure we have a cover and that it is

routinely dusted. Philip suggested we purchase a new one and repair the old one as a backup. John did some research that said there is information that our old unit was prone to problems. Proposal accepted as presented, by consensus. Sound team will decide which brand of soundboard to buy.

Administrative Business

Meeting Minutes from 05/04/25 – Cori -approved by consensus.

Treasurer's Report - Larry – accepted by consensus.

Secretary's report - Cori – membership & annual meeting - Cori will draft an announcement about voting membership to be read at each dance. Also looking for someone to take over as secretary in November.

WFAC report – any news on contract or speaker? Josh reported that they've not had a chance to look at the speakers. Steve reported that he has contacted WFAC about the air conditioner that is not working. They said they had one bid but need to get a second bid. Valerie indicated that we need to have a backup hall.

Social Secretary Report – Bonnie sent one card to.....

Scheduling Report – Bonnie reported that a new caller Penelope will be calling on June 16. Bonnie reported that she contacted Rick Boyce about the possibility of filling in if we have an emergency cancellation. Deven reported that he is still working on getting Saturday dances scheduled for the rest of the year. Philip indicated that it is important to know schedule for openers and closers for the amount of work they may need to do.

Techno Contra – Bonnie talked with Kenny Greer about it. He suggested we wait until after the summer. Looking at Polly and Kenny and Darlene would be the people to do techno here. Taco Shell is not an option because he lives in Asheville and charges too much.

Philip and Cori suggested that someone off the board bring us a proposal for specifics.

Audrey recalled that the board had already approved doing a techno in September after the Saturday night dance, so Bonnie and Deven can schedule it. Bonnie and Deven pointed out that we talked about an additional techno dance.

Philip suggested that Bonnie ask the techno people to give us a proposal, and we can then facilitate it – target date of 2nd Saturday in September.

Myra suggested that techno not be an afterparty as it would be really late.

Old Business

Everybody's Dance Insurance update – Larry let us know that it would not cost us any additional money to have them on our policy. ED gave Larry the spreadsheet that indicates that they would be making money if they didn't have to pay insurance. ED board agreed that they would like to join our organization. It would be like the relationship we have with the Waltz nights. Charles wondered about ED keeping their TIN? (checking account balance). No proscriptions but benchmark suggestions. Larry indicated that the initial proposal was that ED

arrange for their hall, callers, and bands. Charles said they could be an “adjunct committee” they might not be bound by our bylaws.

Website – Kurt absent, but Cori reported that Kurt has sent out website draft for feedback. Progress being made.

Google Drive progress - tabled

Board retreat: Audrey 7/26 – Audrey reported that we have everyone able to attend except Valerie. Audrey wants to meet with Valerie to get feedback before the retreat and maybe include facilitator Sophia.

Audrey reported meeting with the retreat committee this weekend. Narrowing down the goals. Next steps meeting with facilitator to fine tune the retreat outcomes. Audrey stressed that we need to review our bylaws and well as our financial report (from Larry). Bonnie and Charles will manage the food. Venue confirmed. Audrey also indicated that there are lots of recreational options for during lunch and after the retreat. Carpooling recommended. (bring up at July meeting.)

Touring Band Proposal - tabled

New Business

Memorial Fund – tabled

Length of Saturday dances. Deven would like to see Saturday dances be 3 hours as in the past. Cori and Philip indicated that we need to coordinate with closers as well as bands and callers; but need to discuss pay for bands and callers as they would understandably maybe want more money. Audrey suggested that we take a straw poll about whether folks want Saturday dances to run longer, or whether it is only a small group. Larry suggested that we can really tell if folks want to stay if we count the number of folks who are staying after the break or staying until the end of the break. Bonnie pointed out that we are not seeing a lot of people at the Saturday dances. Philip suggested we look at several components of Saturday dances: bigger snack table, (position of snack table), longer dance, better bands, publicity! Maybe somewhere to go afterwards for folks who want (restaurant etc)

Josh reported that Tricia Gorman is asking for someone to take over planning the Waltz night.

Meeting adjourned at 9:06.

Next meeting: July 13, 2025, 7:00 pm zoom

Proposal for Scheduling Touring Bands for Saturday and Monday Dances – From Steve:

“CCD currently has many (11) excellent regularly scheduled Core Bands which we want to support with sufficient times to play. We also want to support “touring bands” for variety and cooperative spirit.

“Touring Bands may be scheduled 4 times per year, either Saturday or Monday. For "Big Name" Bands with larger expenses, Saturday is preferred. At least two bands may be chosen by CCD and up to two bands who request a date with CCD. CCD’s Scheduler will accept bands’ fees with Board consultation for cases that Scheduler deems above normal.”